

Warming controversies

There is a section of the scientific community that believes global warming is a result of natural phenomena and not due to the rising concentrations of environmental carbon dioxide

Leapfrog Technologies

Leapfrog technologies are a sustainable approach to progress, where the latest technology is not delayed in reaching the world population



Vamsi Krishna, Senior Manager (Technical) AMD India, 10,300 employees globally

Is it cheaper or more expensive (in the long run)?

One of the short-term benefits would be low running cost. With low power consumption, these servers would emit less heat that results in low cooling costs. Looking at the long-term is the realization of data centres return on investment (ROI). Above all benefits comes the responsibility.

How much did you spend last year, and is this year's allocated budget any different?

AMD is making significant R&D investments to develop energy efficiency products, however we cannot disclose details.

Do you do anything special to entice customers to go green?

Saving costs isn't the only driver for investment in Green IT. Today going green is one factor that every CIO keeps in mind. Every technology provider is talking about technologies that are friendly to environment. This results in a positive change in attitude of IT managers when we talk about green.

What changes have you made in your products to be more green?

All latest products from AMD feature the latest energy efficient technologies making them more energy efficient without compromising the performance.

NVIDIA

Tonie Hansen, Senior Manager, Corporate Social Responsibility, 3000+ employees globally, 45+ in India

What's NVIDIA's stand on green?

How high on your agenda is it?

Being an environmentally-conscious company is important to NVIDIA as it's an opportunity to partner with our employees and customers to decrease our collective carbon footprint as well as improve the efficiency with how we operate as a company and engage with our supply chain. Our three focus areas for having a positive green impact are: campus operations, supply chain and product design.

Does your company use renewable power?

We have evaluated renewable power alternatives such as solar and fuel cell, but at this time we have not made a commitment to incorporate them into our energy mix.

What are the most significant changes NVIDIA has made this year to go green? What about the future?

Our most significant change in the past year was the addition of a LEED (Leadership in Energy and Environmental Design) Platinum Data Center in Silicon Valley. In the future, we will continue to evaluate opportunities to make our buildings, products and data centers more energy efficient.

Do you comply to green certifications such as ISO 14000?

Yes, we are ISO14001 certified for our largest campus in Santa Clara.

Is it cheaper or more expensive (in the long run) for NVIDIA to go green?

We have found that most green initiatives require an upfront financial commitment but the pay-back is usually very short and in the long term the ROI is better than a less-green alternative.

What were your 2009-2010 spends towards this, and is the allocated 2010-2011 budget higher or lower?

We're unable to share our budget for green investments. Budgets are integrated into regular business operations.

Do you have any special drives to encourage your customers to go green and recycle your products?

Our Quadro business unit offers a take back program for clients who purchase large quantities of our technology. The technology is donated to the NVIDIA Foundation, which partners with non-profit partners use it for educational initiatives.

How different is the agenda (for all of the above) of your India operations when compared to global operations?

All our offices are expected to maintain full legal compliance at a minimum and work towards incorporating continuous improvement in their environmental programs. We look at all of our larger sites with an eye towards improvements in energy efficiency and decreased waste. One of the key successes to NVIDIA's global green program is to give employees a say in the green improvements they'd like to make to their offices.

Have you changed your products in order to be more green?

In an effort improve battery life in notebook computers, NVIDIA has launched Optimus, that intelligently senses when the GPU is not being used, and shuts it down to increase battery life, allowing consumers to enjoy longer computing time, and improving the life of the battery overall.

Data center intensive businesses have benefited from our Tesla technology. The power of the GPU means companies use fewer computers while getting increased performance, which cuts down on energy. Similarly, Tegra, has a low power management architecture for ultra-efficient power consumption across all use cases. 